



Proactive Communication:

Community Experience Team

Market *insights*

Clients value engineers who take initiative and own their work with minimal hand-holding

According to Forbes, “Resourcefulness [and] the ability to solve problems independently, efficiently and with the resources at their disposal” is specifically highlighted as a top soft skill in tech.

Key traits of autonomous talent:

- ◆ Being self-driven
- ◆ Able to tackle tasks independently
- ◆ Manage time effectively

57%

Andela clients rated autonomy as “critical” to project success.



What the market expects from today's tech talent

Soft skills are no longer optional

Adaptability is a competitive advantage

Critical thinking is in high demand

Communication is a proxy for leadership

Continuous learning signals long-term value



Essential Skills for UX Engineers / Quality Engineers / Data Engineers to Succeed

Quick Guide: What Are The Key Skills Needed to Drive Software Quality?



Seven Soft Skills To Elevate Tech Talent For Business Connection

The Tech Soft Skills You Need To Succeed



Work Trend Index Report: 2025: The Year the Frontier Firm Is Born

What's on the agenda

The mindset shift

Explaining your reasoning

Executive communication

The mindset *shift*

A silent executor



Works silently

An engineer who works silently is not known throughout the organization, and they work in silos. This person does not ask clarifying questions before starting a task.



Lacks context

An engineer who lacks context may not understand why they're completing a task. They don't have a grasp of company wide objectives and little knowledge of the end user.



Reactive

Reactive engineers wait for work to be assigned. They don't anticipate issues or blockers, and may have long periods of inactivity. This person does not start projects independently, or demonstrate problem solving skills.



Low visibility

Low visibility engineers work in the background, and may not showcase their work to the larger organization. This person does little reporting to upper management.

Self-managed team vs task takers

'Self-managing teams are those who are given the autonomy to manage their own work. They determine what to do, who should do it and when it should be done.' -Scrum.org

Task takers



Remain silent and wait for assigned work.



Does not raise issues as soon as they're identified, and does not propose solutions.

Self-managed



A developer that knows the company's north star objectives, and **understands how their work contributes to business goals.**



A developer who doesn't wait to be told what to do when ambiguity arises, they **clarify scope and offer recommendations** aligned with business goals.

Western expectations and business culture

To American clients, trust is earned through reliability, transparency, and proactive communication.



Communication Style

Direct, brief, and assertive, honesty is seen as respect.



Ownership & Accountability

Individuals are expected to “own” outcomes, not just tasks.



Initiative & Proactivity

Anticipating needs, suggesting improvements, and escalating risks early are highly valued.



Collaboration & Hierarchy

Leaders expect you to challenge ideas respectfully

Breakout rooms

You receive a one-line feature request mid-project: "Make the chatbot smarter". The client has completely changed the requirements mid-build.

Do not panic or wait for perfect requirements. Outline the 3 clarifying questions you will ask to reduce the ambiguity.

Explaining your *reasoning*

Communicating effectively and integrating smoothly into teams help projects run without friction

Often just as important as technical skills, clear, proactive communication and strong teamwork are critical qualities for successful engagements.

Clients feel supported when engineers:

- ◆ Keep communication channels open and transparent
- ◆ Flag issues early
- ◆ Collaborate readily across time zones and disciplines



Qualities That Matter

Communication

- Clearly Articulate
- Written and Verbal Skills
- Active Reporting
- Frequent Updates
- Listens and Understands Prompts
- Comfortable Speaking in Meetings
- Explain Decision-Making
- Communicate Blockers
- Document Ideas
- Engage in Discussion

Collaboration

- Team Player
- Integrates Into Team
- Collaborative Work Style
- Gives / Receives Feedback
- Contributes Ideas
- Asks Questions
- Respectfully Disagrees
- Understands Team Culture

Reasoning

Explaining the why behind technical and design decisions, not just the what

Context



Options



Rationale



Recommendation

Best practices

Make communication a habit



Practice explaining your technical work in both complex and simple terms, and always keep stakeholders updated on progress.

Document your decisions



Share how you're driving work forward with progress updates.

Embrace collaboration tools



Regular check-ins, demos, and timely documentation of your work and progress help ensure everyone stays aligned.

Be responsive and adaptable



Being able to communicate in different ways (written, verbal, and across cultures) builds trust with your team and clients.

Executive communications

Open discussion

Have you ever send a report to top management and they were not impressed because they could not understand, or it wasn't what they were looking for? Share your experience, we've all been there!

Effective communication with stakeholders



Avoiding Technical Jargon

Use clear, accessible language to ensure non-technical stakeholders understand the message effectively.



Framing Value and Impact

Highlight cost savings, efficiency, and customer benefits to make updates relatable to business goals.



Be concise

Prepare brief summaries emphasizing key outcomes to engage busy executives and decision-makers.



Use powerful storytelling

Use storytelling to present projects as journeys with challenges, solutions, and results for better engagement.

Executive-Readable Comms

1-3-1 Rule for Asynchronous Updates



Start with 1 recommendation → list 3 options considered → end with 1 ask. Keeps Slack/DM updates concise and decision-friendly.

Pyramid Principle



Start with the main conclusion or recommendation first, then provide supporting details.

Why it works: Executives want the “so what” upfront.

Executive Summaries



Condense complex reports into one page or a few bullet points.

Why it works: Saves time and highlights key decisions

Visual Communication



Use charts, dashboards, and infographics instead of long text.

Why it works: Executives process visuals faster than paragraphs.

Defer Detail, Link Artefacts



Push verbose content to linked PRs, RFCs, or charts. Keep the surface update clean and scannable.

Role play - ***Solid Road***

Your AI model deployment hits a major snag regarding database performance under high load, causing a guaranteed timeline slip.

You must deliver the bad news to the PPM. Practice using commitment language, communicating the blocker proactively, owning the delay without deflecting blame, and immediately presenting your remediation steps.



Q&A

